

Tech Mahindra releases GAIa 2.0 to help enterprises adopt AI and ML faster

Digital services firm Tech Mahindra has announced the release of GAIa 2.0, the latest version of its enterprise artificial intelligence (AI) and machine learning (ML) life cycle management platform GAIa, powered by Acumos.

GAIa is an industrialised version of the open source Acumos platform. Co-created by Tech Mahindra and AT&T, Acumos AI is a platform and open source framework that makes it easy to build, share and deploy AI apps. It is available under LF AI, an umbrella foundation of the Linux Foundation that supports open source innovation in artificial intelligence, machine learning and deep learning.

Tech Mahindra sources say that GAIa 2.0 will enable comprehensive AI and ML driven platform capabilities and services to be deployed across mainstream functions, optimising enterprise operations in real-time across industry verticals.

It offers an enriched marketplace of models and numerous features to empower enterprises across industry verticals to build, manage, share and rapidly deploy AI and ML driven services and applications addressing critical business problems.

‘GAIa 2.0 is a reinvention based on insights and feedback received for the initial version,’ said Manish Vyas, president, communications, media and entertainment business and CEO, network services, Tech Mahindra. ‘We have now incorporated features such as Jupyter Notebook integration, AutoML support, model validation, security and governance that add extremely high value to the business transformation journey of an enterprise, by unlocking and delivering superior connected experiences,’ Vyas added.

Open Mainframe Project expands its ecosystem, adding four new members

The Open Mainframe Project (OMP), an open source initiative that enables collaboration across the mainframe community to develop shared tool sets



and resources, has expanded its ecosystem with the addition of four new members and three new open source projects. The four new members are: Phoenix Software, Syncsort, Western University and Zoss Team LLC. The three newly included projects include: Feilong, Zorow and TerseDecompress.

‘The Open Mainframe Project is a focal point for the deployment and use of Linux and open source software on mainframes,’ said John Mertic, director of program management for the Linux Foundation and the Open Mainframe Project. ‘We are increasing collaboration in the mainframe community, developing shared tool sets and resources and making mainframes, with their underlying compute power, more broadly available. Recent successes and continued international support show fantastic progress in these areas,’ Mertic noted.

Hosted by The Linux Foundation, the Open Mainframe Project comprises more than 30 business and academic organisations that collaborate on vendor-neutral open source projects with the mission of building the community and promoting the adoption of open source on the mainframe. The OMP strives to build an inclusive community through investments in open source projects and programs, career development and events that provide opportunities for the mainframe community to collaborate and create sustainability.

Use of open source software up 68 per cent in 2019

Studies show that the use of open source software (OSS) has increased by 68 per cent during the last one year. Companies attribute benefits such as access to the latest innovations, better security and the ability to customise applications, as the reasons for adopting publicly available solutions.

Meanwhile, SoftwareDevelopmentCompany.co, a B2B marketplace connecting brands with software developers, has released a list of the top 10 open source software as well as best custom software development companies of 2019.

‘One of the most evident benefits of open source software is that many are free to download and use,’ says Gabriel Shaoolian, founder of SoftwareDevelopmentCompany.co. ‘Companies that resort to open source software become more agile, enjoy the freedom of tweaking programs to suit specific requirements and take advantage of the frequent upgrades performed on these publicly available solutions,’ Shaoolian added.

The top five OSS are Linux, Apache, Mozilla Firefox, FileZilla and LibreOffice. The list of the top custom software development companies includes: The Gnar Company, Syberry Corporation, Binariks, Brightscout, Intellias, CognitiveClouds, Techliance, Ionixx Technologies, EMERGE and ArtVersion Interactive, among others.

IBM open sources POWER chip instruction set

Increasing its commitment to open source, IBM announced at The Linux Foundation Open Source Summit recently that it is opening the POWER Instruction Set Architecture (ISA), which is critical to how hardware and software work together on POWER. The move is expected to boost the IBM POWER processor’s value by allowing open source developers to create more innovative hardware components for IBM’s POWER servers.